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SUMMARY

Human rights advocate and program management professional with extensive experience in justice-oriented community development, civic space protection, crisis response, and stakeholder engagement. Skilled in research, policy analysis, capacity building, and partnership development, with a proven ability to work at the intersection of human rights protection, local governance, and civil society strengthening. Over 5 years of professional experience working with national and regional organizations in Nepal, supporting marginalized communities, at-risk human rights defenders, and disaster-affected populations through advocacy, documentation, and access to justice initiatives.

WORK EXPERIENCE

1. Independent Research Consultant & Language Professional (01/2024 - Present)

I. Documentation and Partnership Consultant . SRL Diagnostics, Biratnagar (01/2024 - 04/2024)

- Led research and documentation process for healthcare partnerships between Nepal (Biratnagar) based Indian Pathology Lab called SRL Diagnostics and healthcare institutions in Biratnagar region, Koshi Province;
- Facilitated partnership discussions with healthcare institutions, ensuring alignment with local healthcare regulations;
- Developed detailed documentation framework for potential healthcare partnerships, including MoUs, partnership agreements, and regulatory compliance documents
- Conducted stakeholder mapping and facilitated dialogue with key healthcare institutions in Koshi Province
- Prepared analytical reports on regional healthcare infrastructure, market dynamics, and partnership opportunities

II. Research Consultant . Baseline Research, Sansangai, Nepal (06/2024 - 10/2024)

- Conducted comprehensive feasibility study and needs assessment for community rebuilding initiative in Ligligkot Village of Gorkha district, focusing on holistic community development and rehabilitation strategies;
- Designed and implemented multi-method research approach, including structured community surveys, in-depth stakeholder interviews, focus group discussions and key informant consultations; Analyzed complex socio-economic landscape, identifying critical infrastructure, social, and economic challenges within the Ligligkot community;

- Developed detailed mapping of community needs, infrastructure gaps, and potential rehabilitation opportunities through systematic data collection and comprehensive research methodology;
- Prepared evidence-based recommendations for infrastructure development, including housing reconstruction strategies, water and sanitation improvements as well as educational and healthcare facility recommendations;
- Facilitated inclusive stakeholder engagement, ensuring representation of diverse community groups including women, youth, and marginalized populations;
- Produced comprehensive research report with actionable insights, implementation strategies, and cost-effective rehabilitation proposals;

III. Freelance Translator & Interpreter (09/2024 - Present)

- Translated and interpreted legal and administrative documents for three distinct organizations, ensuring accuracy and maintaining confidentiality
- Managed multiple concurrent translation projects while maintaining quality and meeting deadlines, including non-violent communications workshop manuals, organization's by-laws, and such.
- Provided high-quality English-Nepali translation and vice versa services while preserving cultural context and technical accuracy.

2. Project Officer (07/2021 – 11/2023)

Collective Campaign for Peace, Nepal

- Conducted civic space monitoring events across Nepal's seven provinces, promoting inclusive dialogue and collaboration among stakeholders, including local governments and civil society organizations.
- Led the TIDES Foundation's "Civil Society Innovation Initiatives," facilitating temporary relocation and support for at-risk Human Rights Defenders from Asian countries, showcasing expertise in crisis management and regional coordination.
- Researched and analyzed civic space trends in Nepal, employing Focus Group Discussions, thematic analysis, and data visualization tools (SPSS, Mentimeter), demonstrating advanced research capabilities.
- Designed and executed capacity-building initiatives for underprivileged Human Rights Defenders in Nepal's Far-Western Region, integrating psychosocial support and strategic engagement for resilience building.
- Managed initiatives supporting asylum seekers and persecuted journalists from Myanmar and Bangladesh, providing critical protection, advocacy, and integration support into Nepalese civil society.
- Fostered collaboration with South Asian civil society organizations and the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) of Nepal, strengthening regional advocacy efforts and contributing to policy discussions on human rights and civic space.
- Collaborated with various human rights agencies, including Innovation for Change South Asia and Shelter City Ireland, to enhance regional and international support networks for Human Rights Defenders.

- Organized "Artivism Unleashed: Exploring Human Rights through Art," blending creative arts and human rights advocacy to engage over 150 participants and raise awareness on social justice issues.
- Facilitated workshops addressing misinformation, disinformation, and AI impacts on civil society, partnering with domain experts to empower Human Rights Defenders and promote responsible technology use.
- Drafted comprehensive narrative, monthly, and annual reports, ensuring transparency and accountability while maintaining effective communication with diverse stakeholders, including government entities, NGOs, and international agencies.
- Acquired hands-on experience in administrative and financial management by working closely with Finance and Admin personnel, enabling efficient handling of project budgets and logistical coordination.

3. Program Officer (09/2017-05/2021)

Sansangai, Nepal

- Led initiatives to protect the rights and promote the sustainable livelihoods of the Gurung community post-earthquake, advocating for equitable access to justice and preventing their marginalization by integrating resilience-focused recovery strategies.
- Led school reconstruction and introduced skill-based education programs for the Indigenous Chepang community of Dhading district, fostering their inclusion in mainstream education while preserving cultural identity and heritage.
- Facilitated capacity-building and economic empowerment programs for the Tharu community in Bardiya, collaborating with local NGOs and government entities to enhance economic opportunities and safeguard their socio-economic rights.
- Oversaw diverse community development and disaster recovery initiatives, positively impacting over 1,000 individuals across five communities through reconstruction, livelihood development, and capacity-building efforts.
- Coordinated the reconstruction and rehabilitation of Rainaskot Village post-2015 earthquake, ensuring sustainable recovery and promoting long-term economic resilience through homestay enterprise development.
- Conducted baseline surveys and feasibility studies for the "Rainaskot Homestay" project, utilizing participatory methods including FGDs, KIIs, and surveys to design and implement targeted training programs for local entrepreneurs.
- Acted as a focal point and mediator among local government officials and political stakeholders, fostering consensus and effective collaboration in the implementation of development initiatives.
- Facilitated workshops on sustainable livelihoods and WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene) practices, training over 200 participants to build capacity for healthier living standards and sustainable community practices.
- Coordinated emergency humanitarian responses to flood crises in the Terai region consecutively for three years, ensuring the timely delivery of essential relief and fostering resilience in disaster-affected communities.
- Demonstrated advanced skills in proposal writing, program design, and strategic management, securing funding and partnerships to support diverse development projects.
- Led documentation, reporting, and stakeholder communication strategies, ensuring transparency and effective dissemination of outcomes to local governments, NGOs, and international partners.

4. Program Assistant (07/2016-08/2017)

Youth Thinkers' Society, Nepal

- Facilitated youth participation in global advocacy platforms such as Everest International Model United Nations (EIMUN), ensuring representation of marginalized students from rural Nepal.
- Provided administrative, logistical, and research support for capacity development programs focused on human rights and youth leadership.
- Drafted MOUs, concept notes, and project proposals, supporting international collaborations with entities like the US Embassy Nepal.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

- Collective Campaign for Peace (Project Officer): Led the Civic Space Innovation Initiatives, collaborating with cross-sector experts. Conducted nationwide civic space monitoring using FGDs, thematic analysis, SPSS, and visual tools like Mentimeter for stakeholder engagement.
- Sansangai (Program Officer & Research Consultant): Led baseline surveys and feasibility studies for post-earthquake community projects in Rainaskot, focusing on livelihood models through homestay enterprises. Managed a 5-month feasibility study, overseeing a team of 4 from data collection to reporting.
- Youth Thinkers' Society (Program Assistant): Conducted desk research and secondary data collection for international programs like EIMUN with the US Embassy Nepal. Led community engagement strategies and student exchange initiatives.
- Academic Research: Authored a thesis on Brain Drain among Undergraduate Students in Biratnagar, using descriptive and qualitative methods. Produced a field report on Local Judicial Councils in Resunga and Isma, Gulmi analyzing local governance and justice delivery.

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

- **Master of Arts in Conflict, Peace and Development Studies** (2018 - 2020)
Department of Conflict, Peace and Development Studies, Tribhuvan University
- **Master of Arts in Political Science** (2018 - 2020)
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, Tribhuvan University
- **Bachelor of Arts in Social Work and English Literature** (2014 - 2017)
St. Xavier's College, Kathmandu, Tribhuvan University

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

- Coordinated a two-day medical camp in Bhaktapur, delivering healthcare and education to brick kiln workers in collaboration with JRM Foundation USA.
- Provided translation and interpretation for international medical teams in Lalitpur and Nuwakot, enhancing healthcare accessibility in underserved communities.
- Ensured fairness and transparency as an Election Invigilator during Nepal's 2017 elections.
- Taught Social Studies and Moral Education at Guheswori School, promoting inclusive and ethical values.
- Assisted PhD research on disabled professionals in Nepal, contributing to the advocacy for inclusivity.
- Facilitated role-play and input sessions at Clear Vision Rehabilitation Centre, supporting community reintegration efforts.

REFERENCES

Ms. Natasha Wozniak

Co-Founder and Executive Director

Email: natasha@sang-sangai.org

Sangsangai, Kathmandu, Nepal

Mr. Mahesh Bhatta

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Collective Campaign for Peace (COCAP),
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